ASCII MASTER FLOW — PANEL 1/12: Succession decision tree

START -> newly exposed substrate or disturbed former community
NO DEVELOPED SOIL -> primary succession pathway
SOIL AND BIOLOGICAL LEGACIES REMAIN -> secondary succession pathway
DRIVERS -> autogenic community change plus allogenic external forcing
OUTCOME -> contingent trajectory, not one guaranteed endpoint
MUST REMEMBER: Succession is directional community change driven by colonisation,...

ASCII MASTER FLOW — PANEL 2/12: Primary succession rail

BARE OR NEW SUBSTRATE -> pioneer establishment
WEATHERING AND ORGANIC INPUT -> initial soil development
HERBS OR OTHER COLONISTS -> more cover and resource capture
LATER COMMUNITIES -> increasing structural complexity where conditions permit
LIMIT -> no universal species list or completion time

ASCII MASTER FLOW — PANEL 3/12: Secondary succession rail

```
DISTURBANCE -> prior vegetation reduced or removed
SOIL, ROOTS, SEEDS OR MICROBES REMAIN -> biological legacy
RAPID COLONISERS -> early recovery
COMPETITION AND RECRUITMENT -> later community change
LIMIT -> faster than primary does not mean instant or identical recovery
```

ASCII MASTER FLOW — PANEL 4/12: Sere vocabulary map

```
SERE -> complete sequence at one site
SERAL STAGE -> one community within the sequence
LITHOSERE -> rock   PSAMMOSERE -> sand
HALOSERE -> saline   HYDROSERE -> fresh water
XEROSERE -> dry substrate; names identify starts, not fixed ends
```

ASCII MASTER FLOW — PANEL 5/12: Hydrarch and xerarch comparison

```
HYDRARCH -> begins in water or very wet substrate
XERARCH -> begins under dry conditions
BOTH -> may trend toward more mesic regional conditions
PATH -> depends on sediment, soil, colonists and disturbance
CAUTION -> convergence is not one universal sequence
```

ASCII MASTER FLOW — PANEL 6/12: Mechanism fork

AUTOGENIC -> organisms alter litter, soil, shade or microclimate
ALLOGENIC -> flood, fire, erosion, deposition, climate or land use acts externally
FACILITATION -> early species improve later establishment
INHIBITION OR TOLERANCE -> alternative replacement mechanisms
RULE -> identify the driver before naming the mechanism

ASCII MASTER FLOW — PANEL 7/12: Climax theory pressure test

CLASSICAL CLAIM -> regional climate favours a relatively stable climax
PRESSURE -> disturbance history and species arrival differ among sites
MODERN READING -> multiple plausible stable states can occur
DISTURBANCE -> redirects or resets trajectories
VERDICT -> climate constrains but does not uniquely script every endpoint

ASCII MASTER FLOW — PANEL 8/12: Restoration staging ladder

```
1 STABILISE -> erosion, substrate and hydrology
2 REBUILD FUNCTION -> organic matter, soil biota and nutrient processes
3 ENABLE NATIVE RECRUITMENT -> propagules and suitable microclimate
4 RECOVER STRUCTURE -> composition, layering and connectivity
5 MONITOR -> function and trajectory, not planting count alone
```

ASCII MASTER FLOW — PANEL 9/12: Scale vocabulary

```
HABITAT -> place used by a species
ECOSYSTEM -> bounded interacting biotic and abiotic functional unit
BIOME -> broad regional ecological category
FOREST LEGAL CATEGORY -> status under applicable law or interpretation
RULE -> one term cannot silently substitute for another
```

ASCII MASTER FLOW — PANEL 10/12: Biome control matrix

BROAD CLIMATE -> temperature and precipitation pattern
SOIL AND TOPOGRAPHY -> local water and nutrient conditions
FIRE AND HERBIVORY -> maintain or redirect open vegetation
LAND-USE HISTORY -> modifies present composition
BOUNDARY -> biome maps are gradients, not exact site-level lines
CLOSE DISTINCTION: Primary is not secondary succession, pioneer is not universally...

ASCII MASTER FLOW — PANEL 11/12: Open ecosystem firewall

```
GRASSLAND, SAVANNA, SCRUB -> may be natural ecological states
WASTELAND -> administrative or revenue label
FOREST -> legal category in the relevant context
PLANTATION -> land-cover intervention, not proof of restored biome
DECISION -> assess native biome before afforestation
EVIDENCE LIMIT: MECHANISM / STATUS / CAUSATION: State initial substrate, disturbance...
```

ASCII MASTER FLOW — PANEL 12/12: PYQ and monitoring boundary

```
2021 ROUTE -> pioneers surviving on surfaces without soil
2024 ESSAY -> forests and deserts used as a qualified ecological warning
FOREST COVER -> canopy trend, not successional-stage proof
RESTORATION CLAIM -> needs repeated composition, soil and function evidence
LIVE STUB -> adds no succession timeline, biome range or status
```